

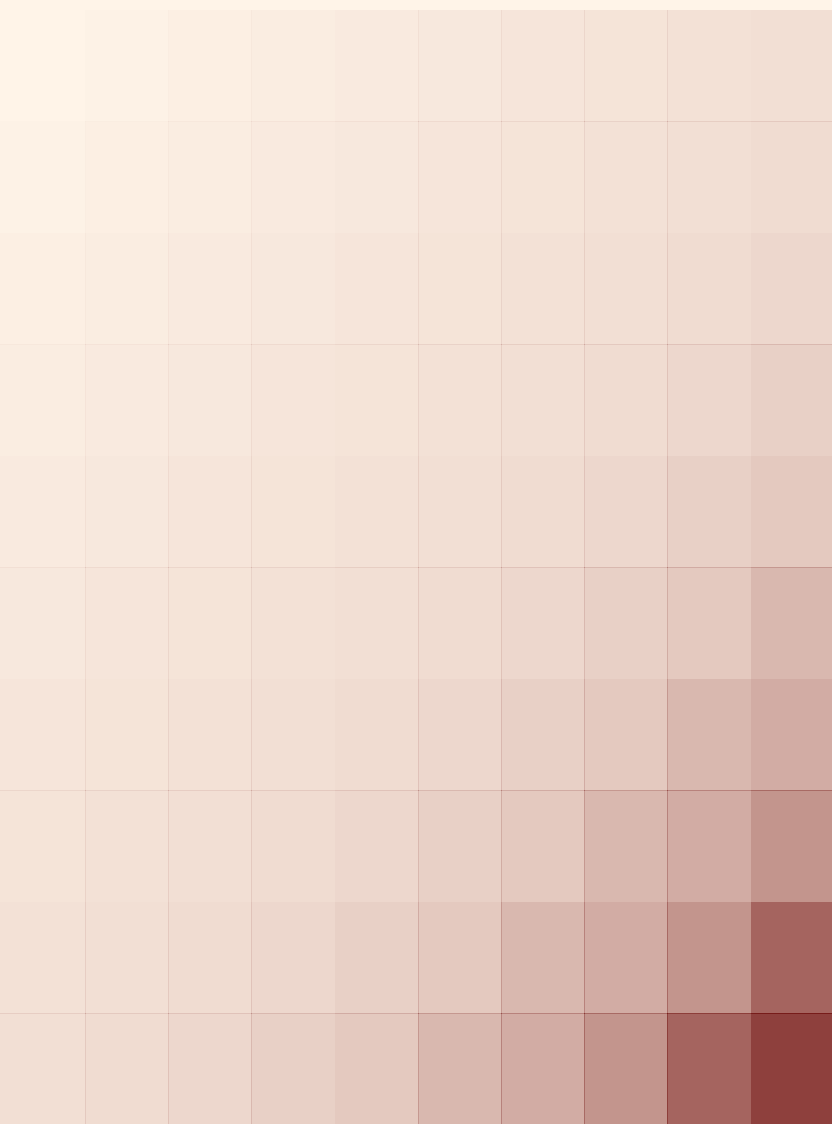
7Wise



The United Kingdom Singapore Student Council

Pre-Departure Booklet

Your guide to the journey ahead!



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01

About

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Wise

THE WISE GUIDE TO STUDYING ABROAD



Meet Wise, the smart way to send, spend and receive money internationally.

It means you can seamlessly start your studies abroad without the hassle of opening a local bank account. Wise works in 40+ currencies and 140 countries so your money can finally match your smarts.

Students



Receive money directly into your Wise account in the currency you need. Get account numbers for GBP (Account number and Sort code), EUR (IBAN), USD (Routing number) and more alongside SGD (Account number and Bank code). It's the smart way to receive payments from around the world.



Stretch your spending budget with the Wise card. You'll get the mid-market rate — the one you'll usually see on Google — and avoid the inflated rates some providers charge. Easily pay around the world and the country you're studying in, with instant transaction notifications to track your spending.



Setting up a Wise account is quick and easy with the help of SingPass. You can move to your university without the stress of getting a local bank account the moment you arrive.

Parents



Send money abroad and set your loved one up for success. Transfer tuition, housing and allowance money with Wise and you could save up to 75%* on fees compared to major banks. Any savings could go towards anything from new books and equipment to a visit home.

Wise

Studying abroad? That's smart.
Paying tuition without hidden fees? That's Wise.

*Savings based on a rate comparison with select competitors in January 2026. To learn more please visit wise.com/compare

Tuition is the first major expense for overseas studies. It could also be your biggest chance to save.

Before you fly

- ✚ With Wise you'll get the mid-market rate on all your international transfers. It's the exchange rate you'll usually see on Google. Banks often charge their own exchange rate so you pay more to send less. Don't be fooled. With Wise what you see is what you get. Transfers are transparent with one low, upfront fee.
- 7 Get account numbers for major currencies like SGD, GBP, EUR and USD so you can send and spend money like a local as soon as you arrive.

Just arrived

- 🏠 Good news, your Wise account is ready to go the moment you touchdown in your University's hometown. With a Wise card you can spend and withdraw cash with zero exchange rate markups. Even better you can add a Wise digital card to Google and Apple Pay for seamless spending.

Settling in

- 📱 Travel smart with a Wise multi-currency card. Spend in 40+ currencies and 140 countries without hidden fees. You can hold multiple currencies in your Wise account, so you'll always have the smart way to pay, worldwide.



Share Wise.
Earn rewards.

- 1 Share your unique invite link with friends who need a smarter way to manage money.
- 2 They start using Wise. When they sign up with your link, they'll grab a sign-up gift: a free transfer or a handy Wise card.
- 3 You earn a reward. And just like that, you'll get rewarded for every friend that qualifies.

Give your money a boost

Most accounts let your money gather dust. With Wise you can put it to work by investing in Wise assets.

Get a one-time return on the currency you hold for everyday spending: 1.01% SGD, 3.44% GBP, 1.7% EUR and 3.41% on USD.

Gold coins shown for illustrative purposes only. The actual return on investment will vary based on market conditions. The actual return on investment will vary based on market conditions. The actual return on investment will vary based on market conditions.



Get started now!
Sign up using UKSSC's referral link:
<https://wise.prfl.hn/1/NkxnZwg/>
(Or scan the code to sign up on your phone)

The UKSSC

The United Kingdom Singapore Student Council (UKSSC) is an independent & student-led organisation operating out of Singapore and the United Kingdom.

The UKSSC seeks to represent the interests of all Singaporeans studying in the United Kingdom: helping Singaporeans find their 'people' across the country, & strengthening the UK-SG community & Singaporean identity by providing support to all Singaporean students.

Vision

To foster a vibrant Singaporean community & sustain the Singaporean identity in the United Kingdom.

Mission

To promote inter-society collaborations, interactions, & connections, & to represent the interests of Singaporean students in the United Kingdom.

What do we do?

1. Integrate Singaporean students
2. Inter-society bonding events
3. Guidance & support
4. Career opportunities and events exclusively by the UKSSC

Meet the 28th UKSSC Committee

Meet Ukssie!

Just like you, I fly back and forth between Singapore and the UK all the time! I'm here to support you, linking you with our huge UK-based Singaporean community to make it feel like home. Let's journey through overseas life together!



Executive Committee



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Intelligence

Singapore Societies

Think of Singapore Societies (SingSocs) as your ultimate piece of home in the UK. Joining a SingSoc is your instant support network, your social hub, and the easiest way to find your footing in a brand-new country.

Don't hesitate to slide into their DMs or drop them an email! Every committee is ready and waiting to welcome you to campus!

London



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United Kingdom Singapore Law Students Society

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president@ukslss.com



United Kingdom Singapore STEM Society

@uksgstemsoc
uksstem1@gmail.com

Singapore Organisations in the UK



Singapore UK Association (SUKA)

@singaporeukassn
ilikesuka@gmail.com



Singapore Young Professionals Network (SYNC)

hello@sync.org.uk



ACS+44

@acsplus44



Hwa Chong (HCOSG)

@hcosguk

Interest Groups



Singapore Medical Society Ireland

@sms.ireland
president@smsireland.com



Rafflesians Unite UK

@rafflesiansuniteuk



Singapore Medical Society of the United Kingdom

@smsunitedkingdom
president@smsuk.com



02

Visa

- ↳ Application Process
- ↳ Visa Appointment
- ↳ FAQs



Application Process

1. Prepare Required Documents (Passport, CAS Number)

- By the time you receive your CAS number, you will be able to apply for your visa (3 months before start of course).
- A reminder: you must accept your offer before a CAS number will be distributed. For conditional offers, please fulfil the requirements ASAP. For those who need to fulfil an English language requirement (especially post NS boys), click [here](#).
- Importantly, if you plan to renew your passport, do renew it before submitting your passport information for the issuance of the CAS number, as asking for a new CAS number might delay your application.
- Singaporeans will not need to submit an ATAS certificate.
- For those who aren't Singaporean citizens, you can check if you require an ATAS certificate [here](#). Subsequently, you can proceed with your application [here](#).
- Most Singaporeans will also not need to submit a tuberculosis test, unless you fulfil [these conditions](#).

2. Complete Online Application

- Apply for your UK Student Visa [here](#).
- Do download a copy of your application for easy reference in the future.
- Most universities should have a Visa application guide you can refer to if you require assistance.

Application Process

3. Make Payment

- It will cost £558 for the UK Student Visa Application Fee.
- Additionally, there is an [Immigration Health Surcharge \(IHS\)](#) fee of £776/year (~£2328 for a typical 3 year course).

4. Schedule Visa Appointment

- After making the payment, you will be sent an email informing you what to do next (booking an appointment with VFS Global) and what to bring to the VFS Global Visa Centre.

Visa Appointment

1. Making Your Appointment

- After payment, an email will be sent to you to book an appointment with VFS Global Visa Centre to obtain your biometrics.
- You may have an option of add-on services. From experience, none of the services are essential as Singapore's processing times are efficient. Nonetheless, you are welcome to purchase these add-ons if you wish.
- Address: VFS Global, 135 Cecil Street #08-01 MYP Plaza Singapore 069536; Tel: +65 6224 1732

2. Documents for Your Appointment

Under the differential arrangement scheme, Singaporeans need not provide evidence to show they meet the financial requirements.

You will only need your passport and passport photo for your appointment (assuming you have uploaded the rest of the documents). However, authorities may audit your application, and so we recommend to still prepare all of the following documents:

- Passport
- Email from your university with your CAS number
(Note: as long as all the parts of your name are reflected and only your surname is capitalised, it is fine).
- Visa appointment letter
- 2 passport photos
- Education transcripts
- Financial evidence
- For those self-funding: Refer to UKVI's list of accepted documents
- For those on scholarships: Letter of sponsorship from your respective bodies

For more information, do visit [Singapore VFS Website](#).

3. Going for your Appointment

Show the security guard your appointment letter. You will then be ushered to the waiting room.

Once it is your turn, a staff member will look through your documents and make any necessary corrections.

They will collect your biometric data. The office will hold on to your passport for a few hours, so be prepared to stay in the area to collect it back.

Using Your Visa

After the appointment, you will need to do final linking of your eVisa to your UKVI account. For more information about eVisas and how to link your UKVI account to them, do visit [UKVI's eVisa Guide](#).

Afterwards, you can show your eVisa anytime by logging into the website.

FAQs

1. How long will the whole visa application process take?

From the time you complete the form to when you receive your visa, depending on availability of appointments, it should take roughly 3 to 4 weeks. You should begin this process ASAP to avoid any complications. Fortunately, Singapore is incredibly efficient; even during peak periods (around August), they tend to be able to push it out!

2. What if my passport is going to expire soon?

We highly recommend for you to renew your passport before sending in your passport information for the issuance of your CAS number. Do note that the passport you are using to apply for the visa **MUST** be the same passport as stated on the CAS.

If you already have a CAS number and wish to renew your passport, we would recommend for you to apply for the visa first with your old passport (assuming it has enough validity for you to travel). You can then apply for a new passport and have it shipped over to the Singapore Embassy in London (once again, they are fortunately very reliable for these sorts of services!).

3. What is a Biometric Residence Permit (BRP)?

As of the beginning of 2025, BRPs have been phased out! They have been replaced with eVisas, which are much more convenient to access.



03

Banking in the UK

- ↳ Overview
- ↳ Types of Bank Accounts
- ↳ Setting up an account from the UK



Overview

Your bank account is useful for payments such as school fees, accommodation, receiving pay if you work, or getting a UK phone number, but many students use other apps and cards like Wise for day-to-day expenses, especially for travel as currency conversions are much more convenient.

It is recommended for students to set up a bank account in Singapore, roughly 1-2 months before leaving for the UK. Alternatively, put this at the top of your priority list as soon as you reach London!

Using Wise

- **Multi-currency storage**

Wise lets you hold and manage funds in 8+ currencies, including GBP — complementing a local bank account. You can convert currencies, make local transfers, and use it for everyday spending once you land.

- **Transparent rates, lower fees**

Wise uses the mid-market exchange rate (the same one you'd see on Google), so there are no hidden markups. You'll only pay a single, clear transaction fee starting from 0.27% — making it cheaper than most banks for converting or sending money, with funds moving accurately and quickly.

- **Spend almost anywhere**

The Wise account can hold 40+ currencies at once and is accepted for spending in 150+ countries — useful if you're travelling around the UK or Europe during term breaks. The Wise card and app support both ATM withdrawals and QR code payments, so you're covered whether you're paying digitally or need cash on hand.



Types of Bank Accounts

Two types of accounts that you can consider setting up from Singapore:

1. Singapore-based Multi Currency Account (e.g. HSBC Everyday Global Account)

- As the account can store multiple currencies, the card can be used for overseas payments in London and Europe.
- Helpful for parents/scholarship providers to transfer money easily (both in SGD and GBP) from a Singapore Bank account without additional transfer fees.
- Bank FX* rates are often not the most optimal. This can be resolved by using a Wise Multi-Currency Account, which offers better exchange rates and local bank details to complement your local SG and UK bank accounts.
- Another tip: After exchanging 20K, you can unlock the HSBC FX Club Silver Tier for a 15% FX discount. This gives you more options to compare rates across banks and providers like Wise to see which meets your needs.

*FX = Foreign Exchange

Types of Bank Accounts

2. UK Bank Account

- There are many options, choose one that is suitable for you (consider interest rates, distance of closest branch to your school/accommodations, benefits, etc.).
- Application forms and information can be found online but for some banks, local branches may also refer you to an international case manager (who will follow up with an email on how to apply).
- Note that it will take some time for them to send your UK bank card to you.
- You may also arrange for the card to be shipped to a UK branch and collect it there, but do allocate sufficient time for queueing, as many other international students will be doing the same thing!
- All regions (except Scotland) will generally opt for banks like Monzo, Chase (one of the highest interest rates!) Lloyds, etc.
- For Scotland, dominant banks are Bank of Scotland and Royal Bank of Scotland (RBS) instead.

Setting up an account from the UK

- Remember to bring along your passport!
- You may require a bank letter from your school confirming your enrolment status which is directly addressed to the individual bank.
[Please note that some banks will not accept the Certificate of Enrolment until you are a fully enrolled student.]
- Some schools (like LSE) have a self-service system for generating a Certificate of Enrolment. However to access this service, you will have to either be pre-enrolled (completed the online pre-enrolment) fully enrolled (completed online pre-enrolment and campus enrolment).
- Some branches (especially those situated around central London like Lloyds) usually have LONG queues at the start of school term, even a few weeks in. So make sure you do it early!
- Do note that UK banks have a system called overdraft: It is basically how much money you can borrow from the bank if your bank balance is insufficient.

[Try not to eat into this as there may be hidden fees but please read the TnCs first!]



04

Life Tips

- ↳ Discounts & Saving Money
- ↳ Adjusting to Life Overseas



Discounts & Saving Money

- **Sign up for membership at the various chains that you frequent to collect points, especially for groceries!**

Sainsbury's → Nectar
Tesco → Clubcard
Lidl* → Lidl Plus
Uber → UberOne
HungryPanda → VIP

*Generally, Lidl is known to have the cheapest ingredients!

- **Other apps to download:**

Unidays and StudentBeans:
Offer great deals for many brands, including restaurants, electronics, and entertainment venues!

TooGoodToGo:
Purchase food that has not been sold for a fraction of the price just before closing time.



Discounts & Saving Money

- **Cook instead of eating out**

Eating out in London can be incredibly costly (one meal out can sometimes cost as much as a week's worth of groceries).

Cooking at home is not only cheaper, but often healthier too. But if you are going out to dine:

- Bring your student ID and ask the staff for student discounts, you never know!
- Always carry some cash around, especially when visiting asian restaurants, as you may be able to get 10% off when paid by cash.
- You can choose to opt out of the discretionary 12.5% service charge at restaurants. If they add it to the bill, just inform the staff and they will remove it.

[Do take note that sometimes they may question you or get the manager to speak to you but do note that you are not legally obliged to pay for it (in other words, it is a tip)]

- **Keep track of your expenses!**



Adjusting to Life Overseas

Moving to a new place can be intimidating, what more a new country.

It is important to develop your support system and to find comfort in wherever you may be:

- **Beating homesickness:**
 - Join societies from home (like SingSoc!) to be in a home away from home :)
 - Bring pictures/memorable trinkets from home to remind you of loved ones.
 - Schedule regular calls with friends and family to stay in touch.
 - Try your hands at making some classic Singaporean dishes when cooking! That way it can remind you of yummy food from home 🏠



Adjusting to Life Overseas

- **Always carry a foldable umbrella/wear water-resistant clothing**
 - London's weather is highly unpredictable! It can be sunny and rainy the next minute.
 - In Scotland and the North, weather tends to be MUCH colder with shorter sunlight hours, so bring thicker coats and frequently take your vitamin D!



05

**National
Health
Service (NHS)**



NHS

Remember to register for the NHS as soon as possible – the lead time is quite long but ensuring that you have healthcare coverage is very important.

You also paid for it when you applied for your visa so access to the NHS is completely FOC!

- To register, you should check out the [NHS website](#) and look at general practitioners (GPs) near your area. This process is entirely free and will not require any proof of address, immigration status and photo ID.
- Choose your GP and submit the online form with your particulars (although it depends on the clinic and some require in-person registration).
- The whole process takes around 5 days but be prepared to wait longer.
- Do check if your school has a GP surgery that you could register with as well!



06

Transport

- ↳ General Hacks
- ↳ Obtaining Regional Smartcard
- ↳ Travelling out of your region
- ↳ School-specific tips



General Hacks

- **Download Citymapper/TFL Go for updates on tube/bus delays, and stay alert for any potential tube strikes!**

These apps would be the most useful in getting directions around London (Citymapper is really useful in other cities as well).

- Tube strikes occur often and heavily disrupt traffic. Expect roads to be crowded and ensure that you have an alternative mode of transport (cycling or walking).
- **If you take the tube often, get the Oyster card!**
It entitles you to student discounts when taking the tube. Same for buses: buying a bus pass on your Oyster card saves you money!
- Get the student Railcard (16–25 years old) which will help you save money as you travel more, be it within London when linked to oyster card, or out to other cities. (Unidays offers a discount on this).
- **Remember to link your Railcard to Oyster Card for additional discounts!**

Transport in London



Linking your Railcard to Oyster

- If you travel frequently, you can save $\frac{1}{3}$ on your off-peak train and Tube journeys by using a Railcard.
- Alternatively, you could buy a monthly travelcard for unlimited travel, which range from £119 to £189 depending on the Zones.
(Based on 18+ Oyster card prices)
- It has to be done in person using a physical Oyster card – do take note that it cannot be added to your mobile wallet.
- Steps:
 1. Register for an oyster card through the TFL website (lead time for the card to be delivered would be between 7-14 days). Application fee would be around £21.
 2. Register for a railcard (16-25 years old for students) – there is an option for 1 year or 3 years which are £35 and £80 respectively.
 3. After obtaining both, go to the station and ask any station staff who will help you complete the process!



Travelling out of London

- **When buying train tickets for the railways, always check out Trainpal or Trainline.**
These platforms run discounts on top of your discounted fare from time to time (but do check between the various providers first).
- **For flight tickets, use Skyscanner to get the cheapest option available.**
Always browse on incognito!



General Hacks

- **Download Citymapper, the Bee Network app, or local operator apps for real-time updates and journey planning!**

While Citymapper is brilliant for navigating major Northern hubs like Manchester, Leeds, and Newcastle, you'll want the region-specific apps (like Manchester's Bee Network app or Newcastle's Nexus app) to check local bus routes and buy digital tickets on the go.

- **Oyster card does not work in the North.**

Instead, get the region's specific smartcard or use the operator's mobile app.

- Almost all Northern buses and trams accept contactless "tap-and-go" (via your bank card or phone) and automatically apply a daily fare cap so you don't overpay. If you're heading to **Newcastle**, look into getting a **Pop card** for the Metro, or a **Walrus/MetroCard** if you are based in **Liverpool**.

Transport in the North



Obtaining Regional Smartcard

- **The 16–25 Railcard offers a ⅓ discount on off-peak train fares with regional operators like Northern and TransPennine Express.**

A must-have for students frequently traveling between Northern cities!

- **Alternatively, you should buy a termly or academic year student bus pass.**

Purchase passes from operators like Stagecoach (called a 'Unirider') or First Bus for unlimited travel, which is vastly cheaper than London pricing (averaging around £250–£350 for an entire AY).

- Identify the dominant bus operator servicing your specific university campus (usually Stagecoach or First Bus) and download their official mobile app.
- **Most apps are predominantly digital!**

Passes can be bought via respective operator's app or loaded onto a digital smartcard. (e.g. Manchester's Bee Card or a Pop card in Newcastle)

Travelling out of the North

- **Check out Trainpal, Trainline, or Split My Fare to save money on split-ticketing (always compare across apps first).**
- **For international or European flights, check Manchester Airport (MAN) on Skyscanner.**

It is a large international hub, so you don't necessarily have to travel down to London to fly off to Europe! Tip: use incognito mode!

School-specific tips

- **University of Manchester**

Download the Bee Network app to access Manchester's unified tram and bus system, and consider a Stagecoach Unirider if living far from Oxford Road.

- **University of Leeds**

You'll likely rely heavily on First Bus Leeds. Consider purchasing a first student year ticket via their app for best value.

- **Durham University**

Most students walk around campus as it is quite compact.

- **Newcastle University**

Should get a physical Pop card or use the Pop app to tap into the Tyne & Wear Metro system, which connects the campus to the city and the coast.

- **University of York**

Most students either walk, buy a second-hand bicycle, or rely on the local First York 66/67 student campus bus routes.



General Hacks

- **Download National Rail, Trainline, or regional bus apps for real-time tracking and journey planning!**

While Citymapper works well in major Southern cities like Bristol, the South of England is largely connected by regional bus networks (like First Bus, Stagecoach, or the Go-Ahead Group).

You will want to download the specific app for your local operator to track bus arrivals and buy student m-tickets (mobile tickets).

- **Oyster card does not work in the South.**

Once you pass the TfL (Transport for London) boundaries, you cannot use your Oyster card.

- Almost all Southern bus operators accept contactless "tap-and-go" payment via your bank card or phone. If you are based in the South West, look into getting a Rider card or a Travelwest account for multi-operator bus travel.

Transport in the South

Obtaining Regional Smartcard

- **Getting a Railcard saves you 1/3 on off-peak train fares.**

This is especially vital in the South, where many students live in neighboring towns and rely on regional trains to commute to campus.

- **Alternatively, you can buy student season tickets or network keys.**

In Oxford and Brighton, operators utilize a smartcard system called 'The Key', though mobile apps have largely replaced physical cards for student discounts.

- Check your university transit page to see if they partner with local operators (e.g. Brighton & Hove Buses or Oxford Bus Company) for exclusive student app discount codes!
- Purchase your digital student keys or passes via the provider's app, keeping your physical university ID on hand to show ticket inspectors.

Travelling out of the South

- **Check out Trainpal or Trainline.**

The South is heavily connected to London via lines like Southern, Thameslink, and South Western Railway.

- **For international or European flights, best airports to go to are London Gatwick (LGW) and London Heathrow (LHR).**

But honestly, whatever airport works for the cheaper air fares.



School-specific tips

- **University of Oxford & University of Cambridge**

Students usually walk or cycle.

- **University of Sussex**

Students are eligible for the Unizone train ticket, which grants unlimited, discounted rail travel between campus (Falmer station) and central Brighton.

- **University of Bristol**

Bristol is very hilly, so many students living in Clifton or city accommodations heavily utilise First Bus Bristol's student passes via the First Bus app.

- **University of Southampton**

The university runs its own dedicated bus network called Unilink, and students living in university halls often receive a free Unilink bus pass included in their rent.

- **University of Surrey**

The campus is split between Stag Hill and Manor Park, so students frequently walk or buy a Guildford student bus pass from Safeguard/Stagecoach to get between sites and the town center.

- **University of Exeter**

Exeter's Streatham campus is quite steep as well, so many students rely on local buses or the railcard for trips down to the St Davids train station.



Transport in the Midlands

General Hacks

- **Download Google Maps or region-specific apps (like the NCTX app in Nottingham) for updates on bus/tram delays, and stay alert for localised transport strikes!**

These apps would be the most useful in getting directions around the Midlands (Citymapper is really useful in other cities as well).

- Oyster card does not work in the Midlands. Instead, download the network app of the city's major transport provider. Buying a dedicated student network pass saves you a lot of money too!

Obtaining Regional Smartcard

- **The Railcard helps you get 1/3 off off-peak train fares including cross-regional routes.** (useful for those who want to visit London, which is just a short train ride away).
- **Alternatively, you can buy an academic year student pass for unlimited travel.**

In Nottingham, the NCT Student Pass covers the massive bus network, while Birmingham utilizes the Swift Card or National Express West Midlands apps.

- Locate your city's prime network (National Express in Birmingham, NCT in Nottingham) and sign up for a student account using your university credentials.
- It is heavily digitised. Most student passes are stored directly as QR codes inside your smartphone wallet or transit apps, completely bypassing the need to register in person.



Travelling out of the Midlands

- **Use Trainpal or Trainline.**
Birmingham New Street is the central rail hub of the UK, making train travel to any corner of the country very easy.
- **For flight tickets, check Skyscanner for options from Birmingham Airport (BHX) before booking London flights as it could save you an unnecessary trip to London. Always browse on incognito!**

School-specific tips

- **University of Nottingham**
The campus has its own direct tram line, so students should purchase an NCT Academic Year Bus & Tram pass to commute between University Park and the city.
- **University of Birmingham**
They have their own dedicated 'University' train station on campus, making a rail-linked contactless bank card or Swift card essential for travelling into Birmingham New Street.
- **University of Warwick**
The campus is technically located in Coventry, so students living off-campus should buy a National Express Coventry/Bus pass for the daily commute.
- **Loughborough University**
Most students walk or cycle, but the local Sprint bus offers cheap student singles into town.
- **University of Leicester**
The campus is concentrated near Victoria Park and is a short walk from the train station, so public transport is only needed to travel out of the city.
- **University of Sheffield**
Students usually rely on the Supertram system, making a Stagecoach student tram ticket an essential purchase.



General Hacks

- Download Google Maps or local network apps (like the Lothian Buses app in Edinburgh) for updates on service changes, and stay alert for severe winter weather alerts!

Heavy snow or high winds can occur often and heavily disrupt train networks and bridge crossings. Monitor travel alerts closely during winter months.

- Tube strikes occur often and heavily disrupt traffic. Expect roads to be crowded and ensure that you have an alternative mode of transport (cycling or walking)
- If you travel by bus and are under 22, Scotland offers an incredible free transit scheme for young residents.
- Same for trams/subways! Get the student railcard (16–25 years old) which will help you save money as you travel more.

Transport in Scotland

Obtaining Regional Smartcard

- **The railcard helps you get 1/3 off off-peak train fares on all ScotRail routes, even for trips across Scotland or taking the train down to England.**
- **Alternatively, if you are under 22 years old and living in Scotland, the National Entitlement Card (NEC) grants you completely FREE bus travel across the entire country!**
 - This process must be done officially online or through the local city council, requiring formal proof of your Scottish student address (like a bank statement or university letter).
 - Go to the official getyournec.scot website to register.

Travelling out of Scotland

- **Use Trainpal or Trainline.**

Can try the Caledonian Sleeper overnight train for a unique experience to London Euston!
- **For international or European flights, instead of London airports, can browse Edinburgh Airport (EDI) or Glasgow Airport (GLA) as they have pretty good links as well.**

School-specific tips

- **Edinburgh University**

Unless you are <22 years old, look into an Edinburgh Student Ridacard for discounted, unlimited travel on Lothian buses and city trams.
- **Glasgow University**

Students should register for a Subway Smartcard online to secure discounted student fares across the city loop.
- **University of St. Andrews**

There is no train station or internal transit system, so students usually walk or use the bus (using NEC) if they need to visit nearby cities.
- **Queen's University Belfast**

Free Scottish cards do not apply here (as it is in Northern Ireland); students must instead apply for a Translink yLink card to get 1/3 off all Ulsterbus and NI Railways travel.
- **Robert Gordon University & University of Aberdeen**

Both located in Aberdeen, so students rely on First Aberdeen or Stagecoach Bluebird buses, both of which fully accept NEC.
- **University of Dundee**

Students usually walk, but for longer city commutes students use Xplore Dundee buses, which are free for those holding an under-22 NEC card.

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